



PARISHRAM 2027

Lecture 1

THE LAST LESSON

(Part - 01)

English

-By Anurag Tyagi Sir

Topics to be Covered

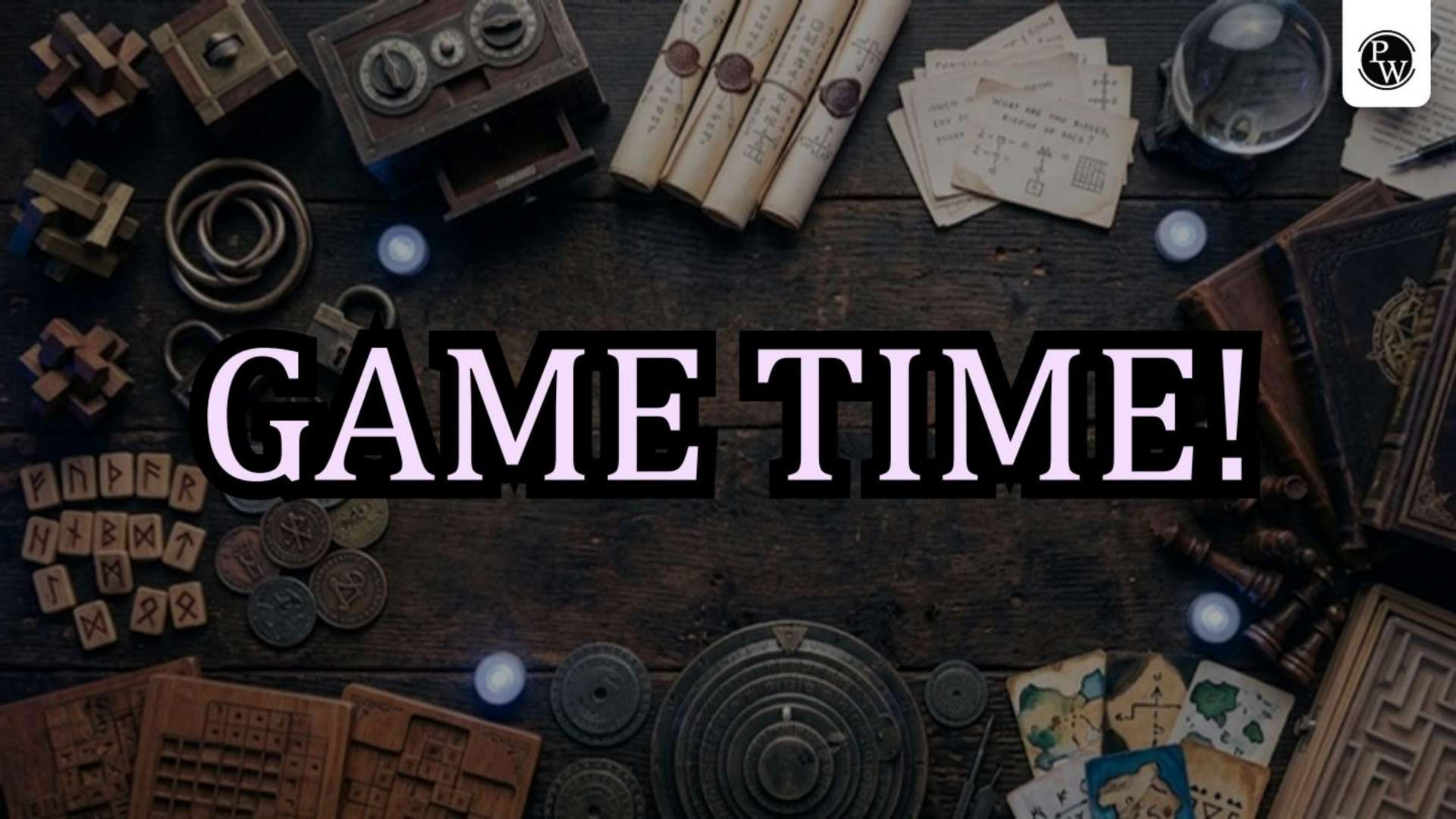
1 Game

2 Flamingo: The Last Lesson (Part - 01)

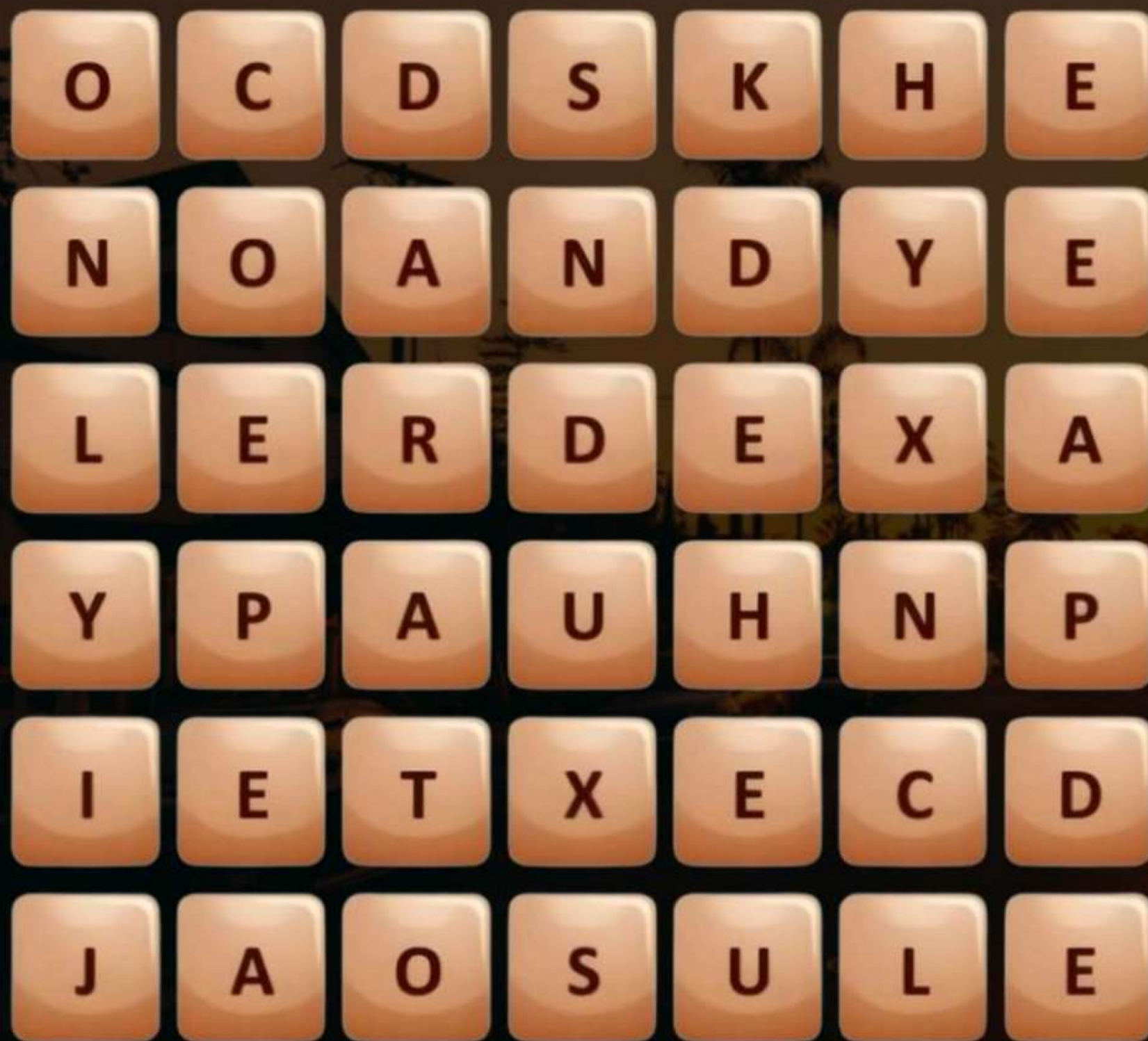
3 Questions



GAME TIME!



Unjumble as many words as possible!



TOPIC:

Emotions

Unjumble as many words as possible!



S H O C K E D

N O A N D Y E

L E R D E X A

Y P A U H N P

I E T X E C D

J A O S U L E

→ Annoyed

→ Relaxed

→ Unhappy

→ Excited

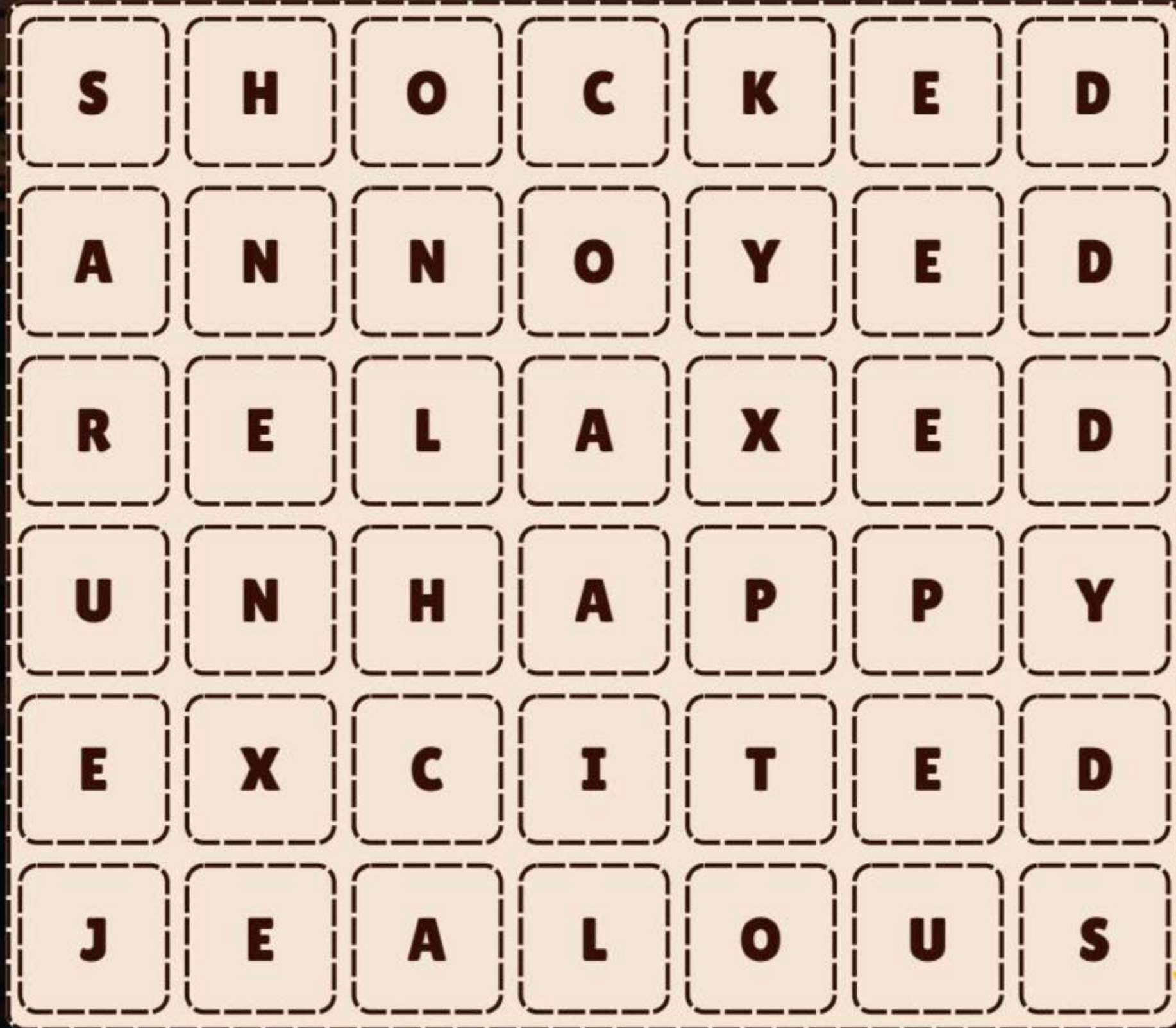
→ Jealous



TOPIC:

Emotions

Unjumble as many words as possible!



TOPIC:

Emotions

Question 1



They tried to keep the project under wraps

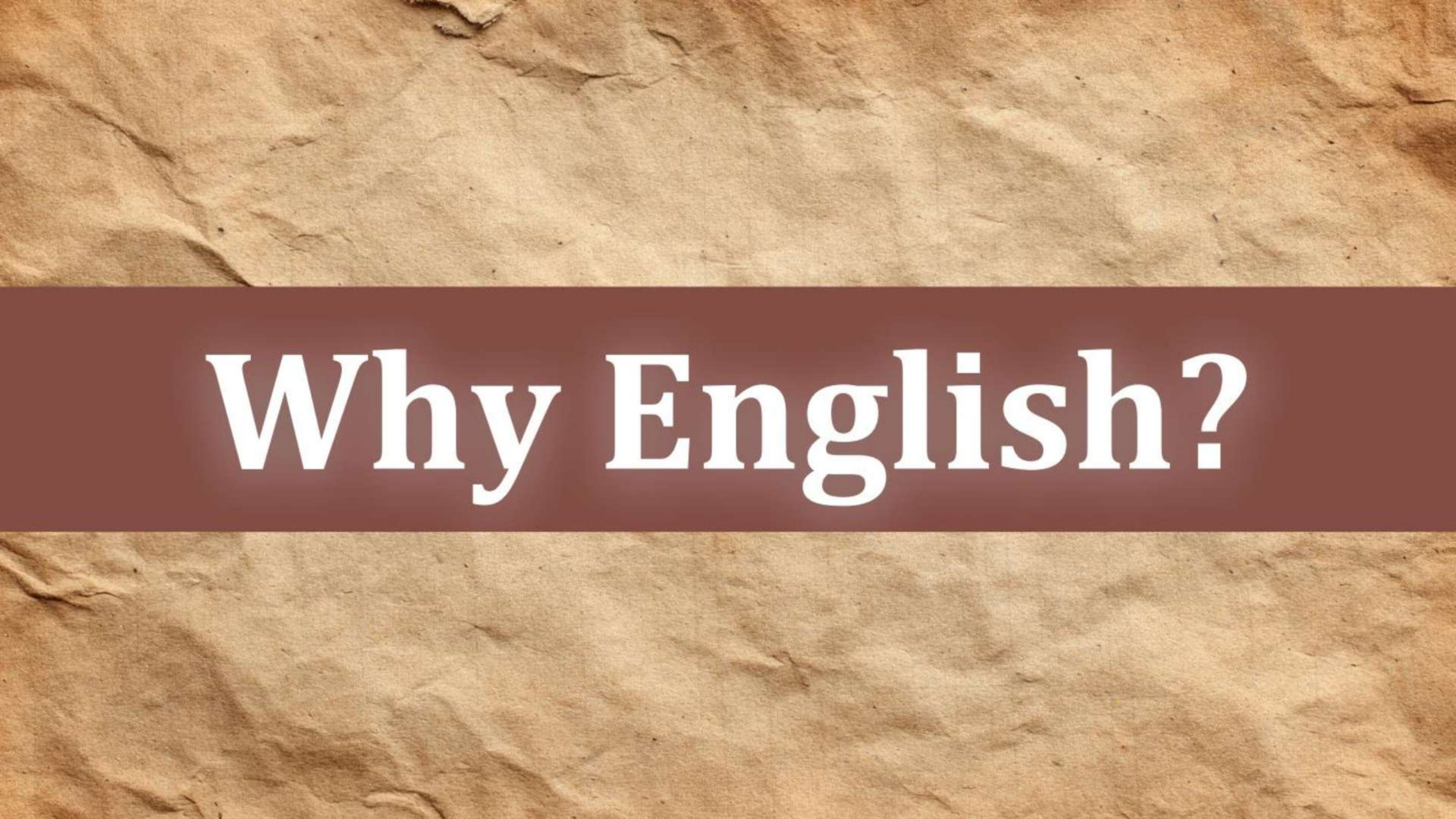
- ✓ A) Keep a Secret**
- B) Finish quickly**
- C) Exaggerate Something**
- D) Reveal a plan**

Question 2



When it started raining, they decided to call it a day.

- A) Work late**
- B) Postpone the task**
- ✓ C) End the work for the day**
- D) Start a new task**



Why English?

Exam Pattern

80/80

Section	Topic	Marks
A	Reading Skills	22 Marks (2)
B	Creative Writing	18 Marks (4)
C	Literature	40 Marks

19

How to Study?

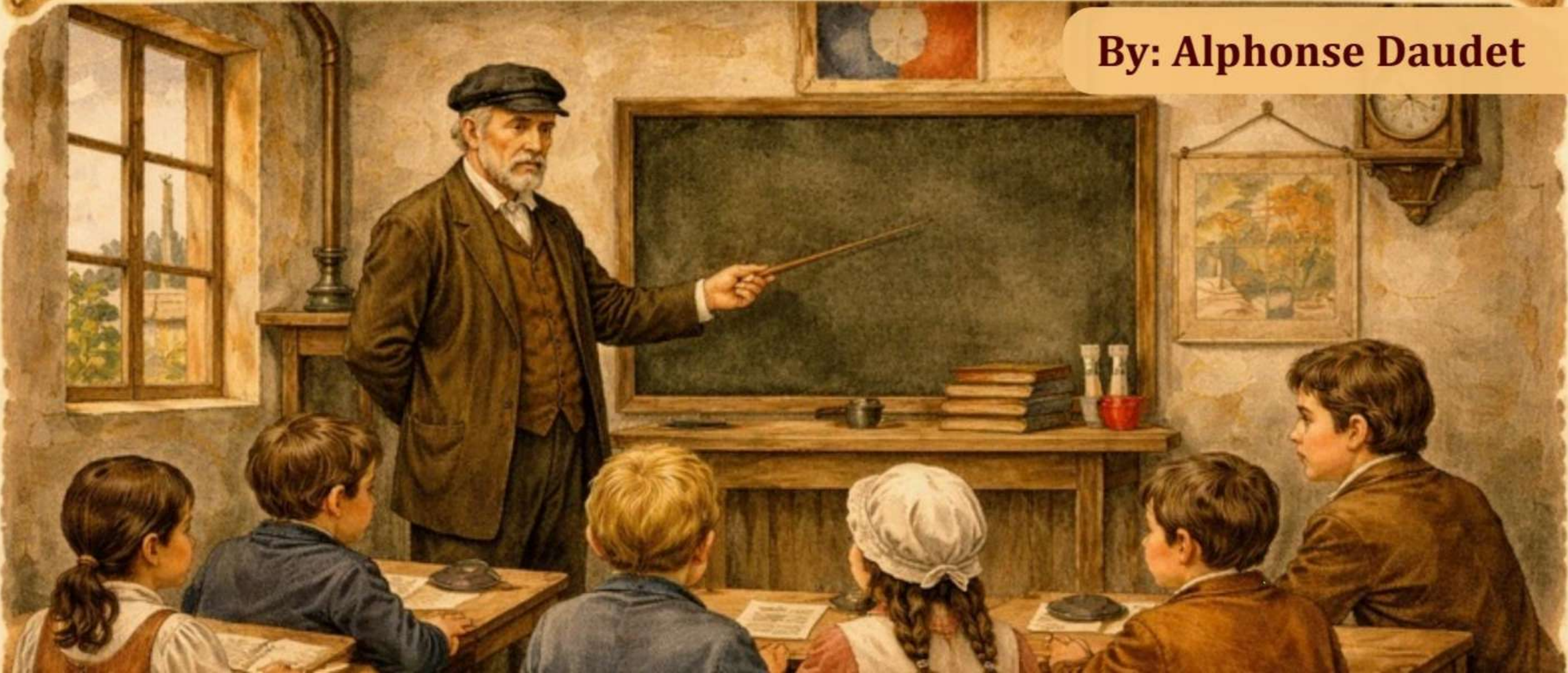


- ✓ 1 Take regular classes
- ✓ 2 Make Notes
- ✓ 3 DHA/HW
- ✓ 4 Practise Writing Answers/ Writing Skills
- ✓ 5 Regular Tests



The Last Lesson

By: Alphonse Daudet



Introduction

- The Last Lesson is set in the days of the **Franco-Prussian War (1870–1871)** in which France was defeated by Prussia led by **Bismarck**.
- Prussia then consisted of what now are the nations of **Germany, Poland** and parts of Austria.
- In this story the French districts of **Alsace and Lorraine** have passed into Prussian hands.



- The story deals with the implications of linguistic chauvinism.
- The story is narrated by a young schoolboy, Franz. His observations convey the arrogance of Prussians who attempted to rule over not only the territory of French people, but also over their minds and hearts.



About the author

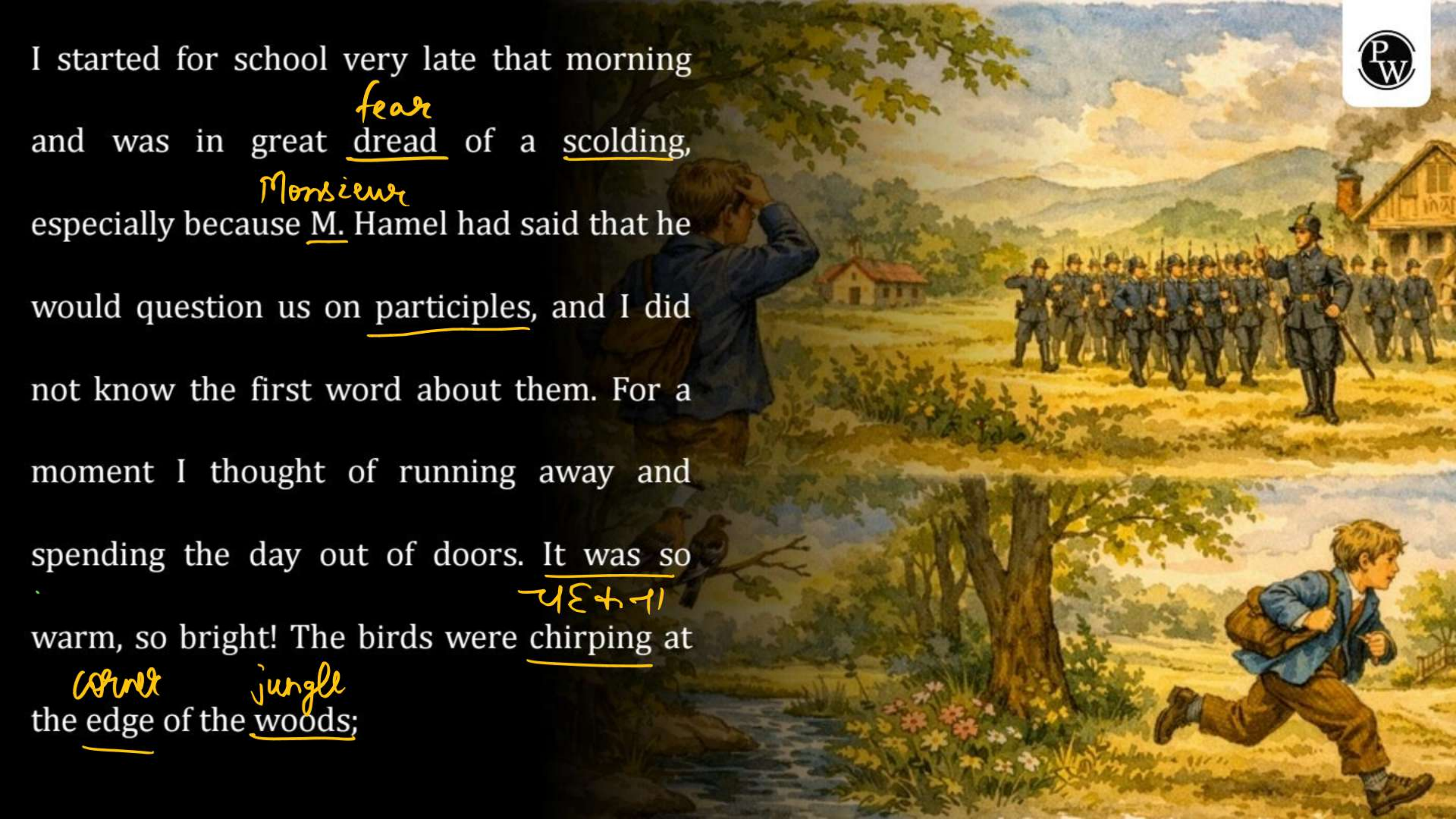


- **Alphonse Daudet** (1840–1897) was a French novelist and short-story writer.
- Born in Nimes, **France**. He initially pursued a career in **law** but later turned to **literature**.



I started for school very late that morning
and was in great fear dread of a scolding,
Monsieur especially because M. Hamel had said that he
would question us on participles, and I did
not know the first word about them. For a
moment I thought of running away and
spending the day out of doors. It was so
warm, so bright! The birds were chirping at
the corner jungle edge of the woods;

-4E4-41



and in the open field back of the
factory sawmill the Prussian soldiers
were training drilling. It was all much
more attractive tempting than the rule for
participles, but I had the
power to put off
strength to resist, and hurried
off to school.



When I passed the *a local govt. building* town hall there was a crowd in front of the bulletin-board. For *notice board* the last two years all our bad news had come from there — the lost battles, the *compulsory service in army* draft, the orders of the commanding officer — and I thought to myself, without stopping, “What can be the matter now?”

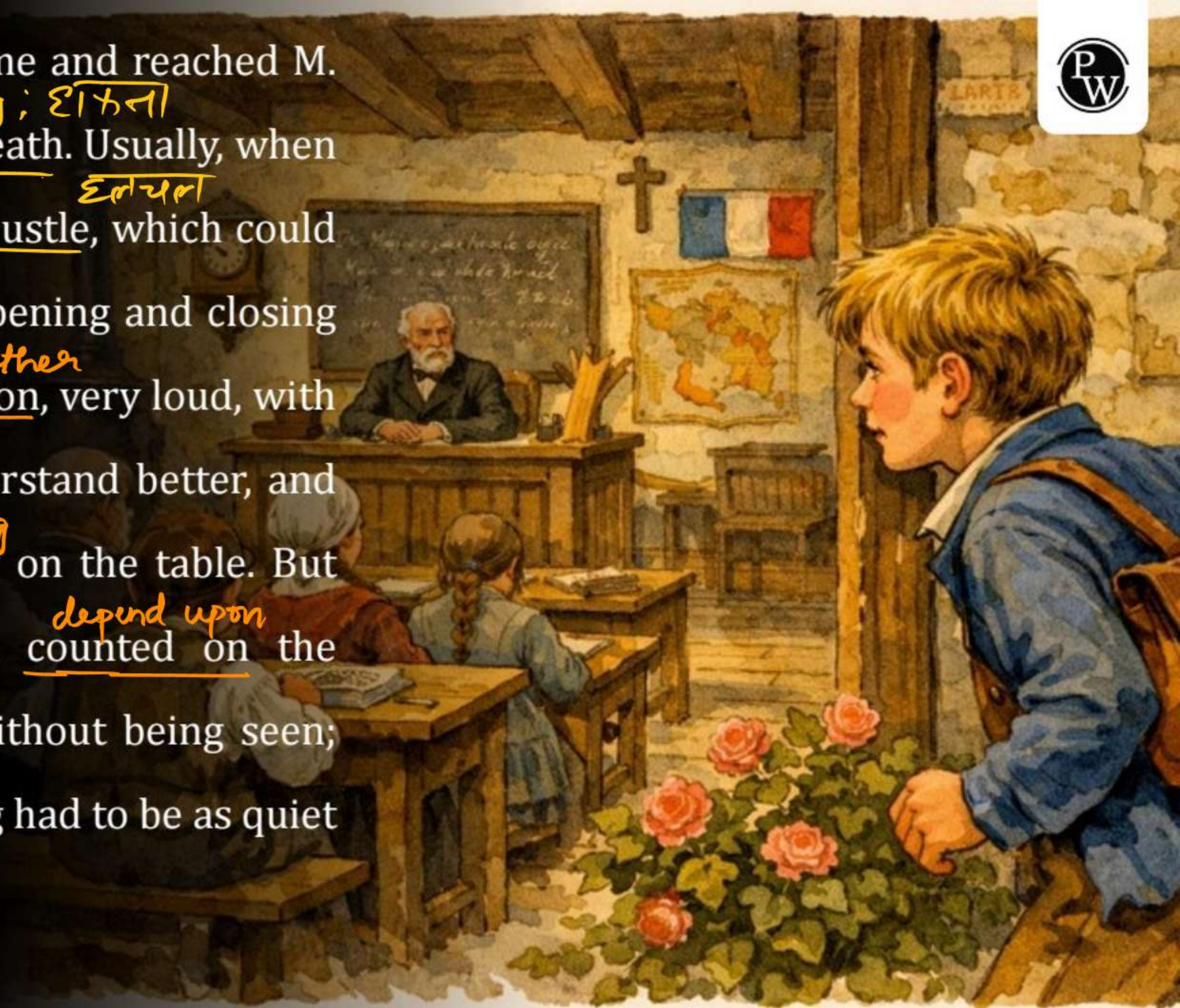


Then, as I hurried by as fast
as I could go, the blacksmith,

Wachter, who was there, with
his apprentice, reading the
bulletin, called after me,
“Don’t go so fast, bub; you’ll
get to your school in plenty of
time!”

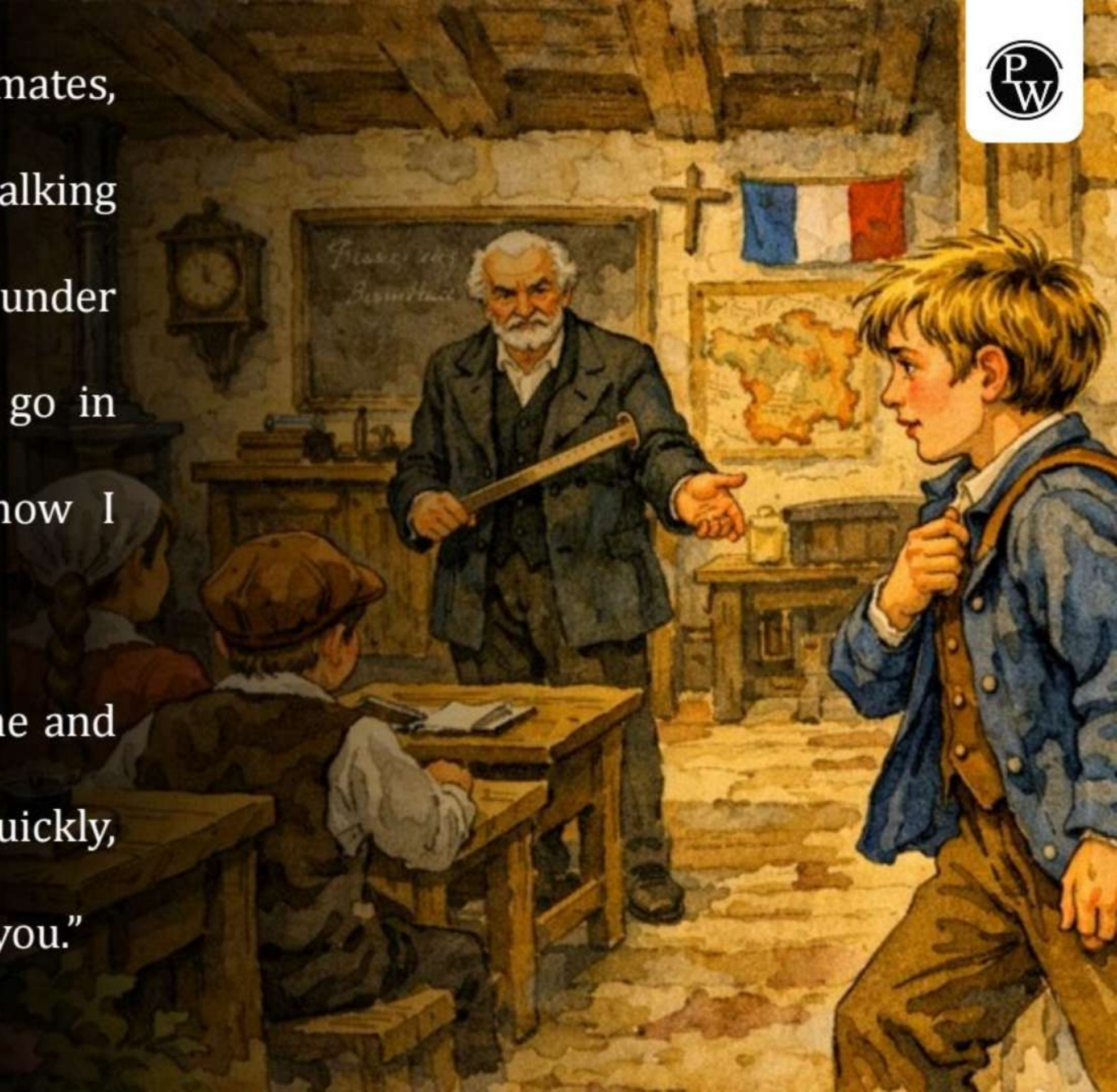


I thought he was making fun of me and reached M.
Hamel's little garden all out of breath. Usually, when
school began, there was a great bustle, which could
be heard out in the street, the opening and closing
of desks, lessons repeated in unison, very loud, with
our hands over our ears to understand better, and
the teacher's great ruler rapping on the table. But
now it was all so quiet! I had counted on the
noisy confusion; शोर-शरावा
but, of course, that day everything had to be as quiet
as Sunday morning.



Through the window I saw my classmates, already in their places, and M. Hamel walking up and down with his terrible iron ruler under his arm. I had to open the door and go in before everybody. You can imagine how I *embarrassed; शर्माया* *scared* blushed and how frightened I was.

But nothing happened. M. Hamel saw me and said very kindly, "Go to your place quickly, little Franz. We were beginning without you."



Question 1



What tempted the narrator to skip school and spend the day outdoors?

A) The warm weather and chirping birds ✓

B) The sound of soldiers drilling ✓

C) The bulletin-board news

✓ D) Both (a) and (b)

Question 2



Why did the narrator feel embarrassed upon entering the classroom?

- ☒ **A) He was late and everyone was already in their places**
- ☐ **B) He forgot his homework**
- ☐ **C) He was scolded by M. Hamel**
- ☐ **D) He couldn't answer M. Hamel's question**

Question 3



What did Franz notice that was unusual about the school that day?

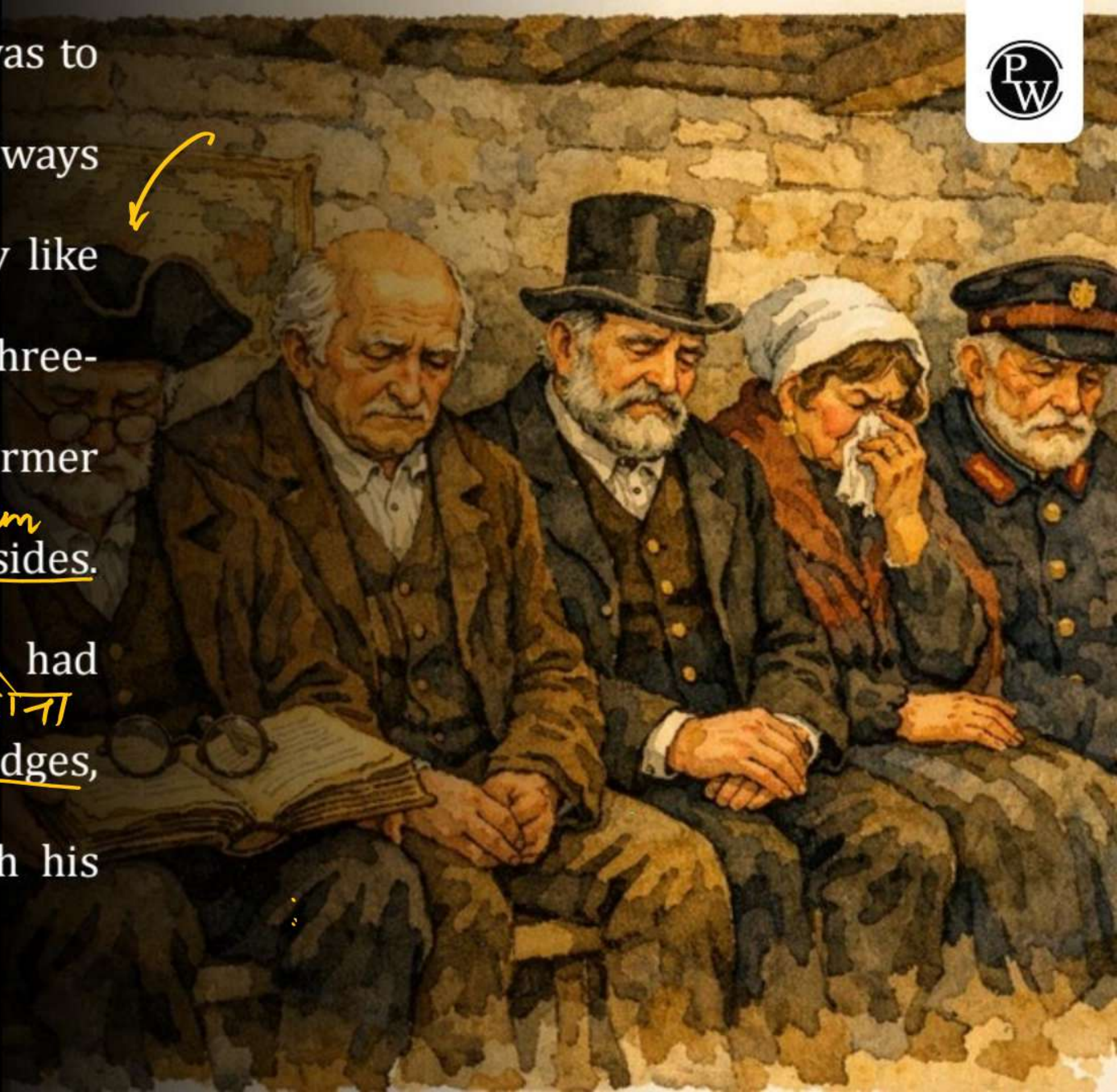
- A) The school was closed.**
- B) M. Hamel was absent.**
- C) The students were playing outside.**
-  **D) The school was unusually quiet and solemn.**

I jumped over the bench and sat down at my desk. Not till then, when I had got a *controlled fear* little over my fright, did I see that our teacher had on his beautiful green coat, his frilled shirt, and the little black silk *ढाँडी* cap, all *decorated* embroidered, that he never wore except on inspection and prize days. Besides, the whole school seemed so *serious; डिट्ट* strange and solemn.



But the thing that surprised me most was to see, on the back benches that were always empty, the village people sitting quietly like ourselves; old Hauser, with his three-^{past}cornered hat, the former mayor, the former postmaster, and several others ^{next to them} besides.

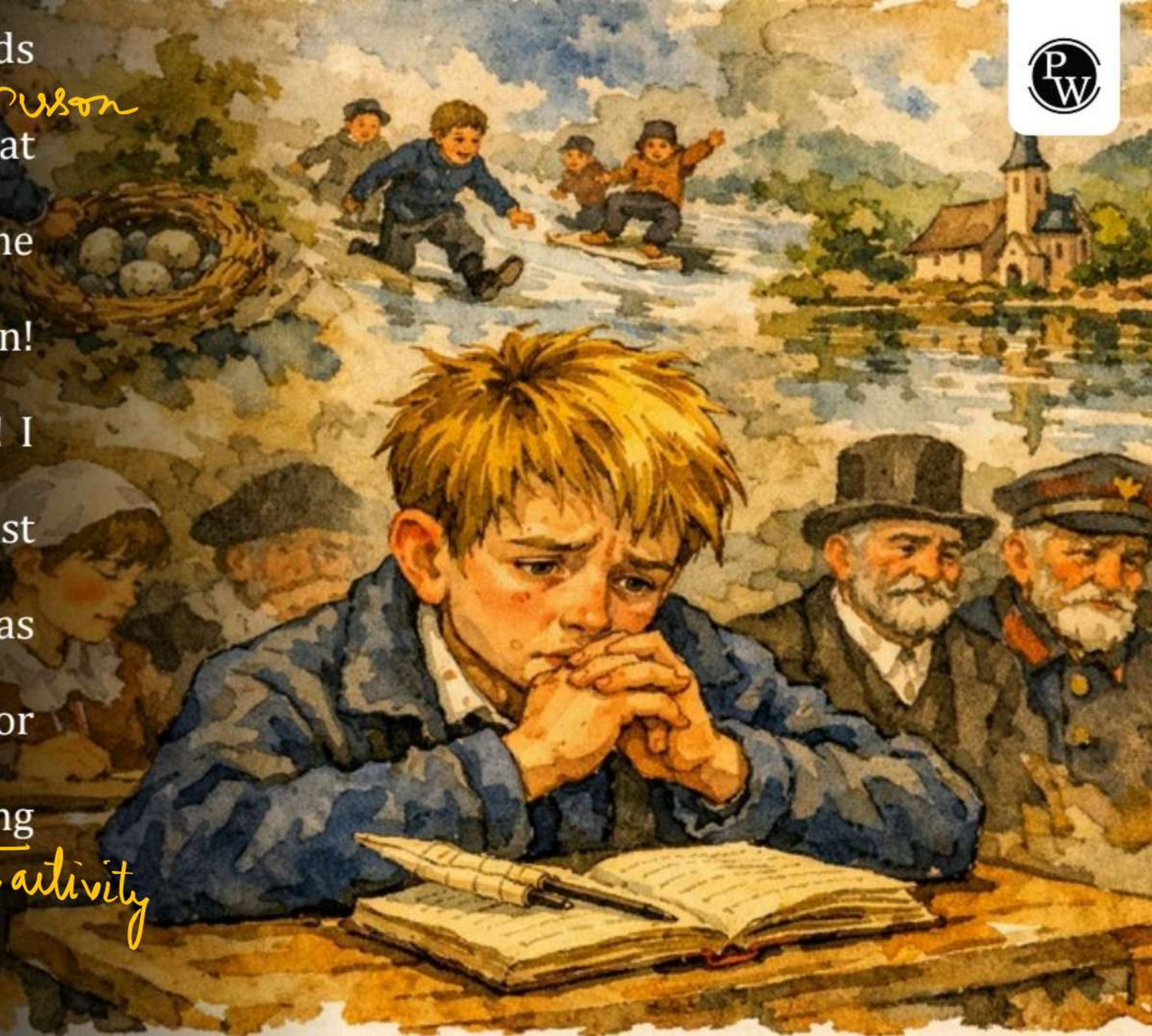
Everybody looked sad; and Hauser had brought an old ^{book} primer, ^{worn out; बिरो होना} thumbed at the edges, and he held it open on his knees with his ^{पश्चिम} great spectacles lying across the pages.



While I was ^{thinking} wondering about it all, M. Hamel mounted his chair, and, in the same serious soft grave and gentle tone which he had used to me, said, "My children, this is the last lesson I shall give you. The order has come from Berlin to teach only German in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine. The new master comes tomorrow. This is your last French lesson. I want you to be very attentive."



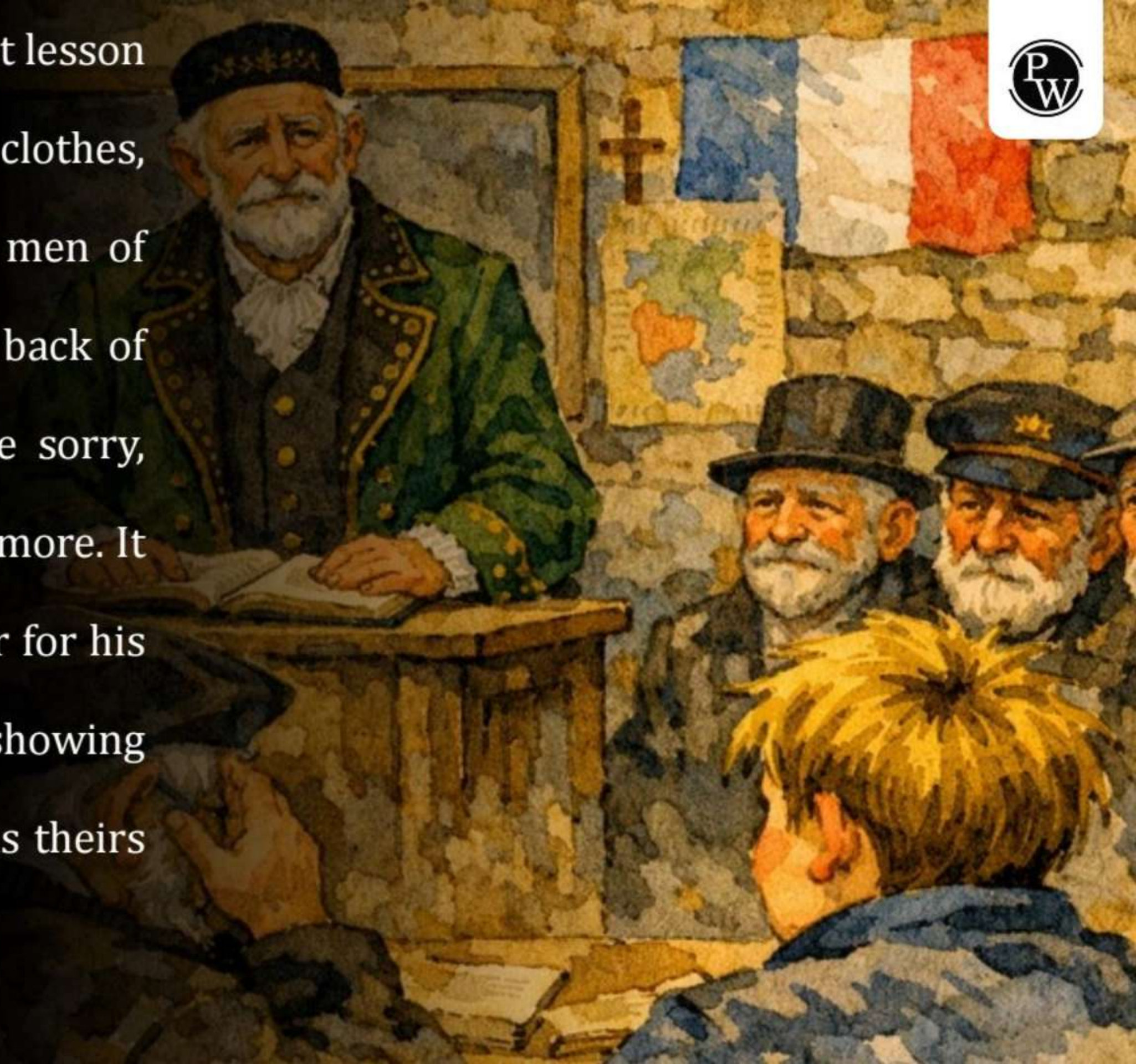
What a thunderclap these words
sudden jolt *evil person*
were to me! Oh, the wretches; that
was what they had put up at the
town-hall! My last French lesson!
Why, I hardly knew how to write! I
should never learn any more! I must
stop there, then! Oh, how sorry I was
for not learning my lessons, for
searching
seeking birds' eggs, or going sliding
river
on the Saar! *playing activity*



My books, that had seemed such a *irritating* nuisance a while ago, so heavy to carry, my grammar, and my history of the saints, were old friends now that I couldn't give up. And M. Hamel, too; the idea that he was going away, that I should never see him again, made me forget all about *सनकी* his ruler and how cranky he was.



Poor man! It was in honour of this last lesson that he had put on his fine Sunday clothes, and now I understood why the old men of the village were sitting there in the back of the room. It was because they were sorry, too, that they had not gone to school more. It was their way of thanking our master for his forty years of faithful service and of showing their respect for the country that was theirs no more.



While I was thinking of all this, I heard my name called. It was my turn to recite.

What would I not have given to be able to

Scary; difficult

say that dreadful rule for the participle all

through, very loud and clear, and without

Confused

one mistake? But I got mixed up on the

gripping

first words and stood there, holding on to

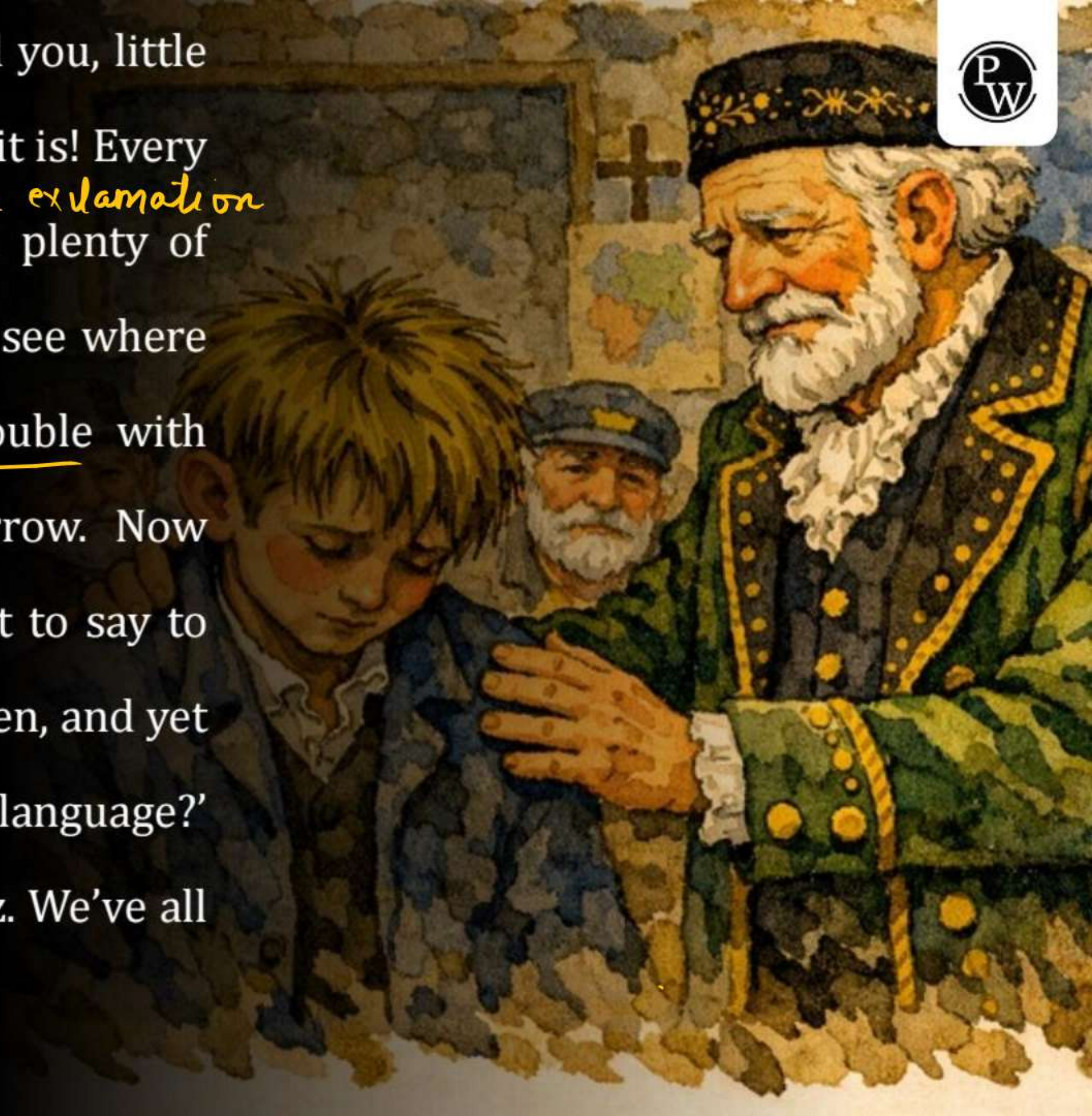
my desk, my heart beating, and not daring

to look up.



I heard M. Hamel say to me, "I won't scold you, little Franz; you must feel bad enough. See how it is! Every day we have said to ourselves, *dismissive exclamation* 'Bah!' I've plenty of time. I'll learn it tomorrow.' And now you see where we've come out. Ah, that's the great trouble with Alsace; she *delays; postpones* puts off learning till tomorrow. Now those fellows out there will have the right to say to you, 'How is it; you pretend to be Frenchmen, and yet you can neither speak nor write your own language?'

But you are not the worst, poor little Franz. We've all *a lot of things* a great deal to reproach ourselves with. *blame; criticise*



Question 1



What was the announcement made by M. Hamel during the lesson?

- A) There would be a surprise test**
- B) He was retiring**
- C) The school would be closed indefinitely**
-  **D) Only German would be taught in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine**

Question 2



How did the narrator feel upon realizing it was their last French lesson?

A) Relieved

B) Excited

✓ C) Disappointed and regretful

D) Indifferent

Question 3



Why did M. Hamel say the people outside would reproach the students?

- A) For not attending school regularly
- ✓ B) For not being able to speak or write French properly
- C) For not respecting their teachers
- D) For being late to class

Question 4



Which of these words reflect the mood of M. Hamel? Select the correct option.

- | | |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| ✗ 1. Cheerful - happy | 4. Delighted ✗ |
| 2. Sad ✓ | 5. Despondent (मिथरा) ✓ |
| 3. Repentant (Regretful) ✓ | 6. Sanguine (cheerful) ✓ |

A) 1, 3 and 5

✓ B) 2, 3 and 5

C) 1, 5 and 6

D) 2, 4 and 6

Question 5



What changes did the order from Berlin cause in school that day?

- A) The school became noisy and crowded as usual.
- ✓ B) M. Hamel gave his last French lesson; everyone was serious, and the villagers came to attend the class.
- C) The students were asked to leave school immediately.
- D) The school started teaching German on the same day.

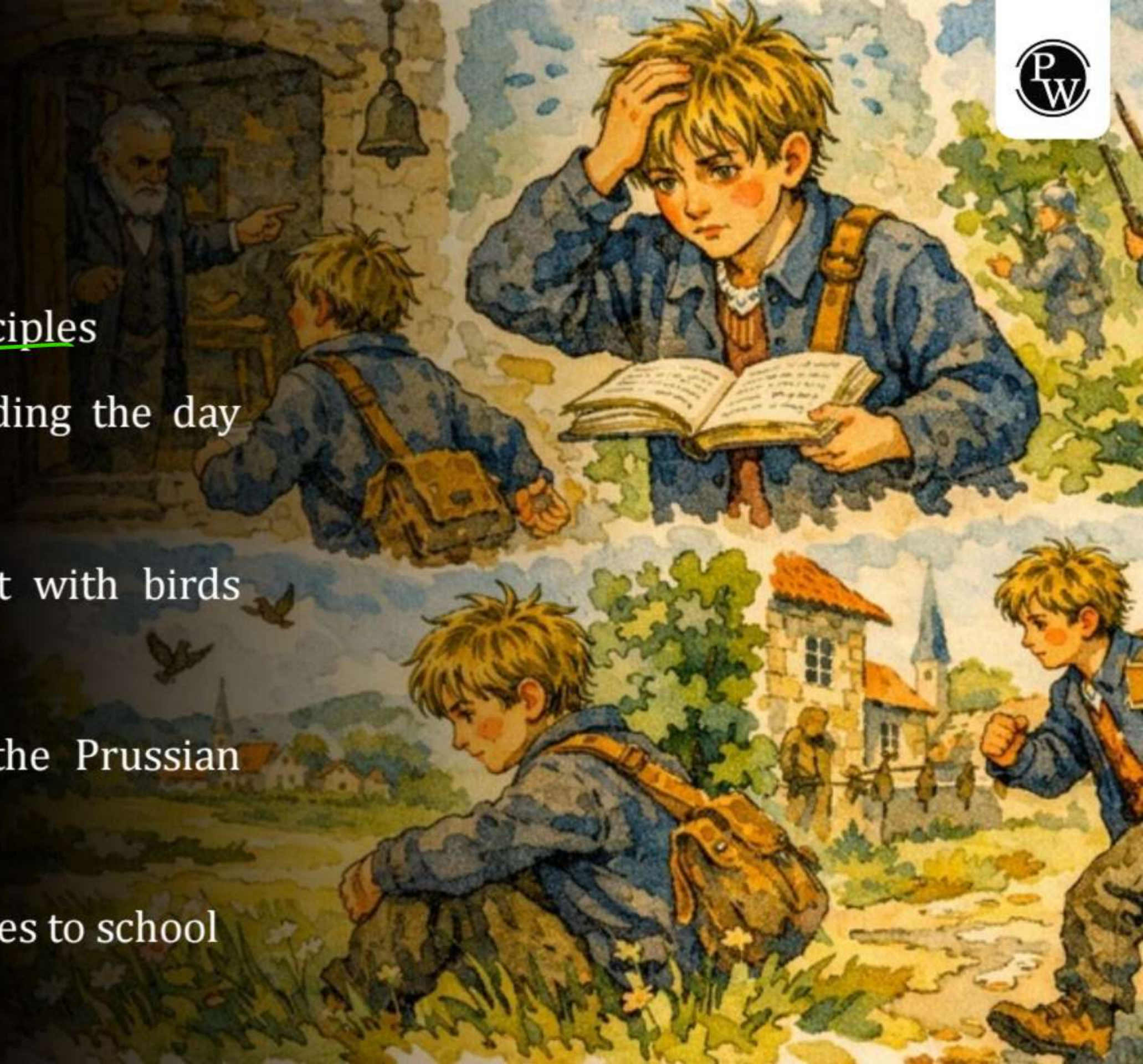
Topic: Key Notes



- **Franz's fears while going to school**
- **Scene at the town hall**
- **Usual scene at school**
- **Changed scenario that day**
- **The classroom surprises Franz**
- **M. Hamel's startling revelation**
- **A grim realisation dawns on the narrator**
- **A tribute by the villagers**
- **Narrator's failure and the teacher's response**
- **Lack of learning: Hamel's view**

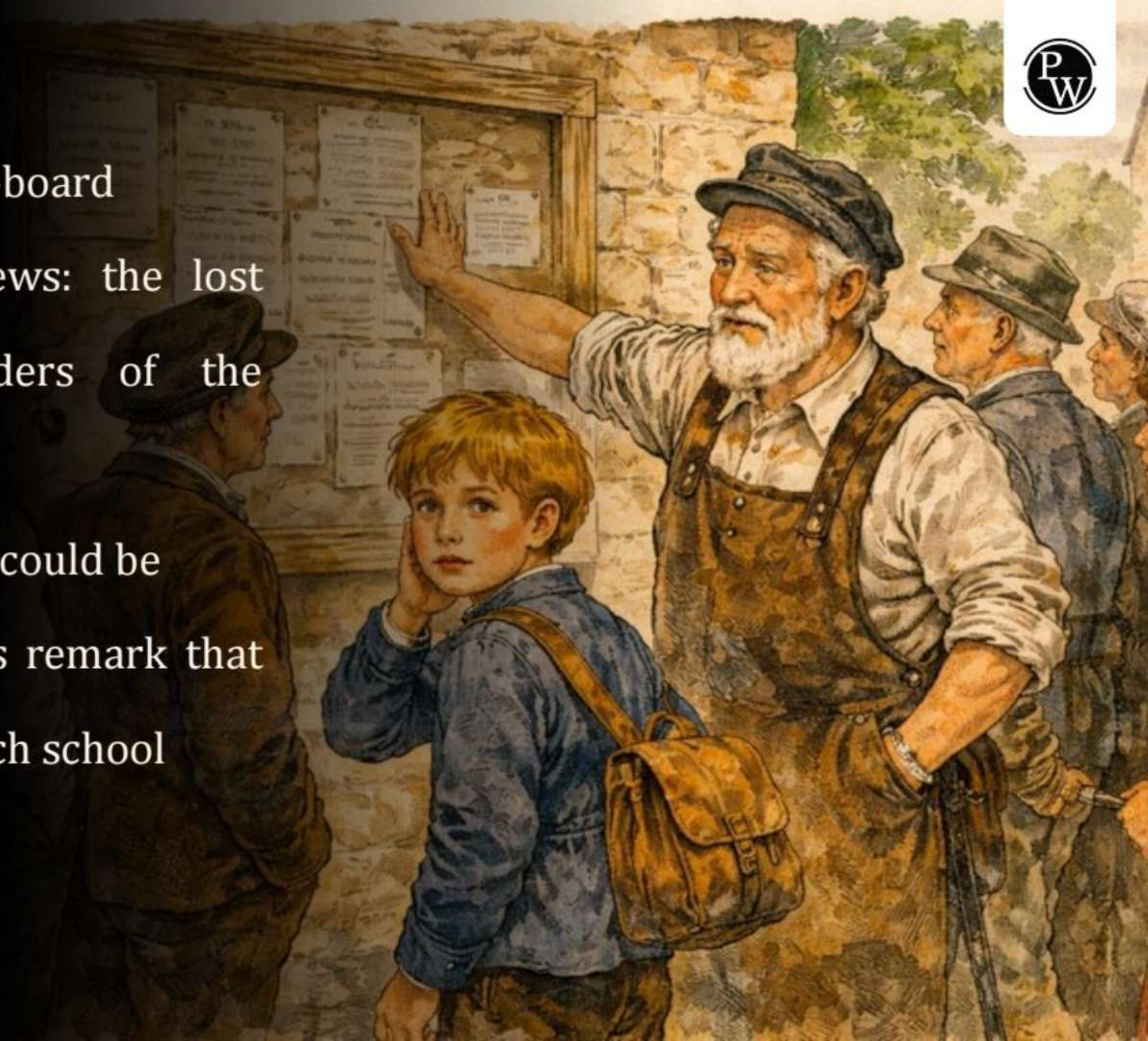
Franz's fears while going to school

- late for school
- dreads teacher's scolding
- had not learnt his lesson on participles
- thinks of running away & spending the day outside as:
 - the day was warm & bright with birds chirping
 - he was tempted to watch the Prussian soldiers drilling
- overcomes temptations and hurries to school



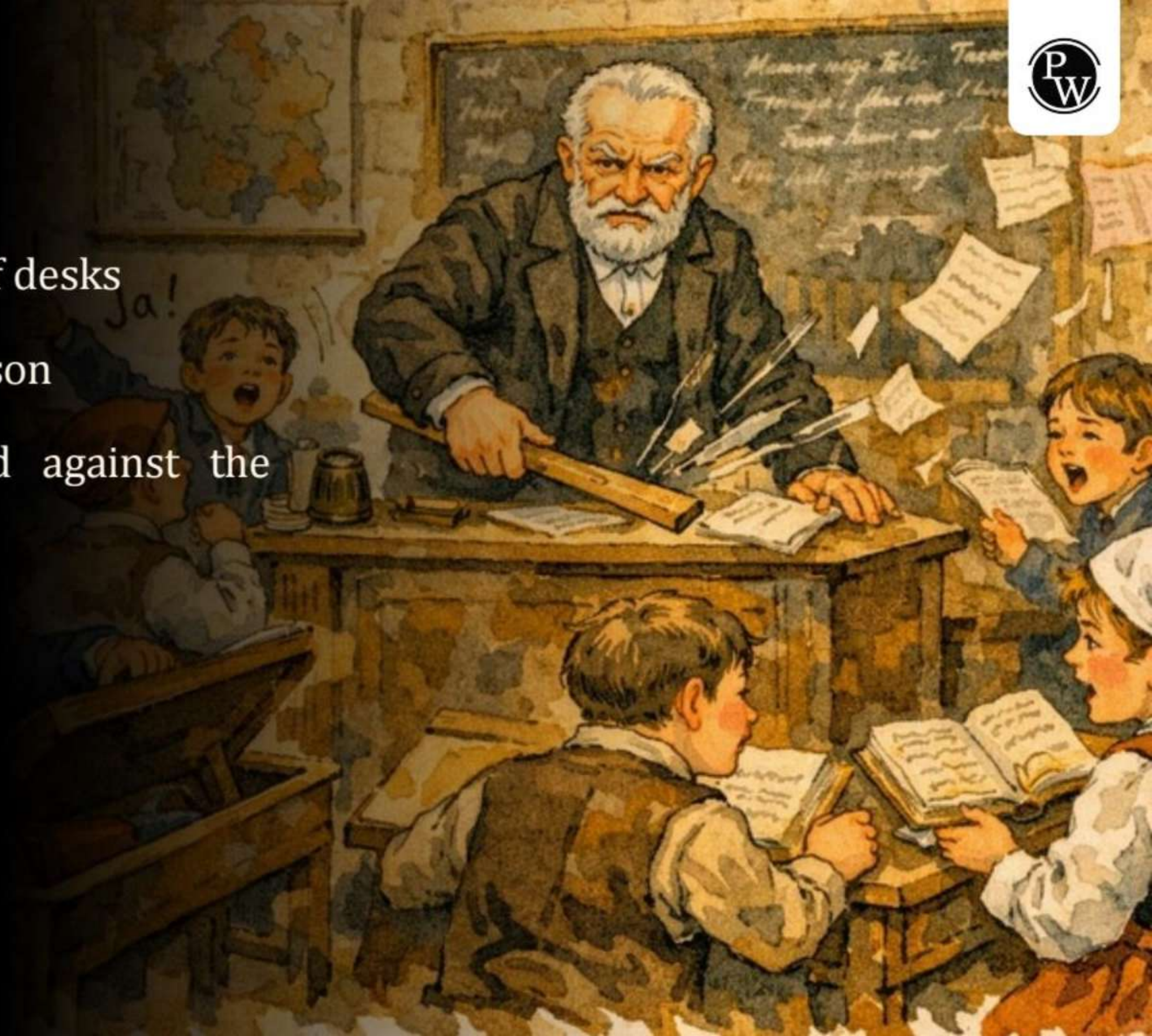
Scene at the town hall

- a crowd in front of the bulletin-board
- it was source of all bad news: the lost battles, the draft, the orders of the commanding officer
- Franz worries what the matter could be
- astounded by the blacksmith's remark that there was plenty of time to reach school



Usual scene at school

- began with a great bustle
- noise of opening and closing of desks
- lessons repeated loudly in unison
- teacher's ruler striking hard against the table



Changed scenario that day

- everything very still and as quiet as Sunday morning
- all classmates already in their places
- M. Hamel pacing up and down with the ruler under his arm
- Franz frightened to enter



The classroom surprises Franz

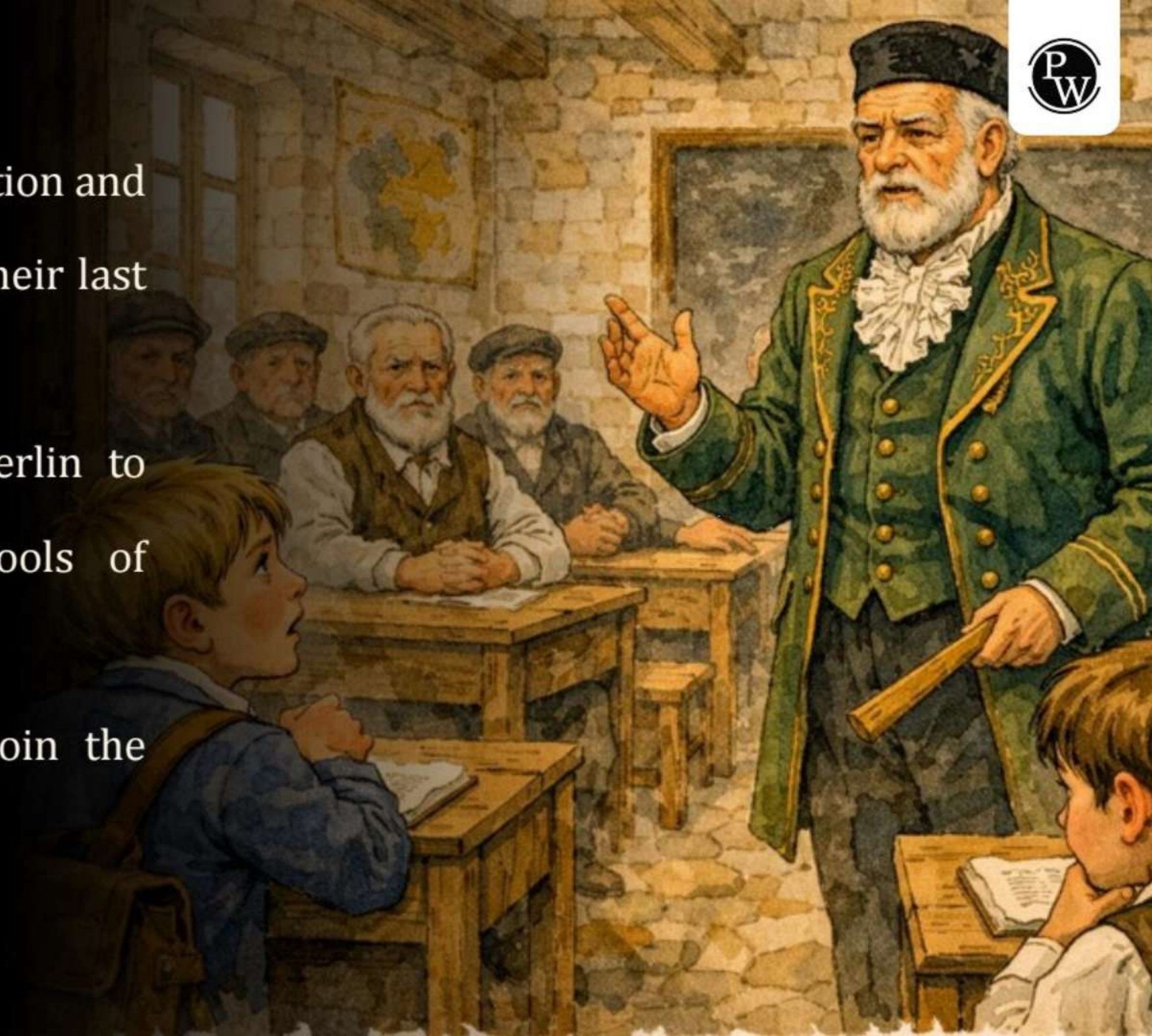


- M. Hamel unexpectedly kind
- had put on his beautiful green coat, frilled shirt and an embroidered black silk cap which he normally wore only on inspection and prize days
- entire school wore a strange and serious look
- strangely enough, back benches occupied by the village people



M. Hamel's startling revelation

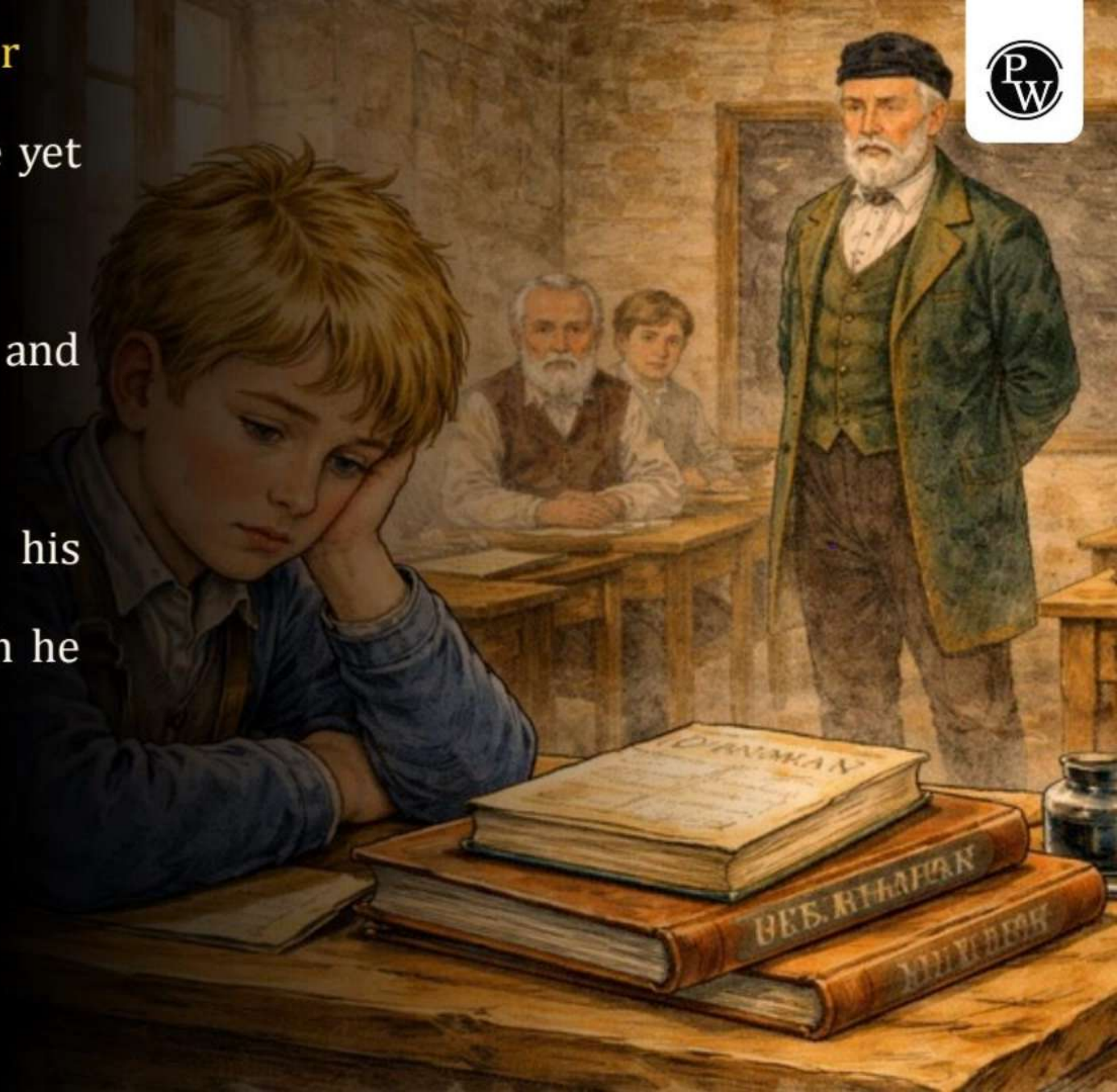
- M. Hamel demanded full attention and announced that it was to be their last lesson in French
- had received orders from Berlin to teach only German in schools of Alsace and Lorraine
- new teacher was going to join the next day



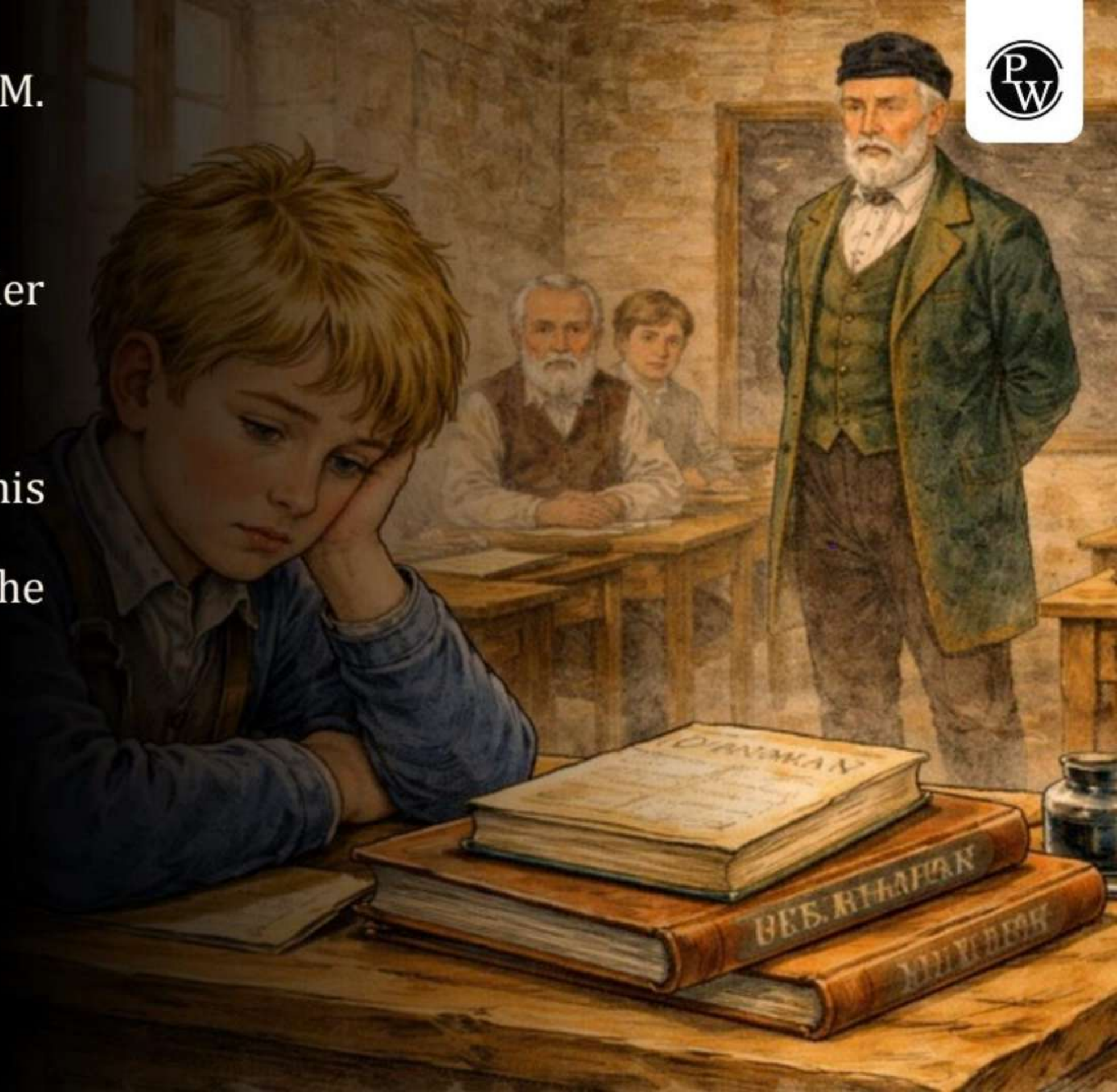
A grim realisation dawns on the narrator



- realised that he had so much more yet to learn
- felt sorry for whiling away his time and skipping his lessons
- now did not want to part with his books of grammar & history, which he had earlier considered a nuisance

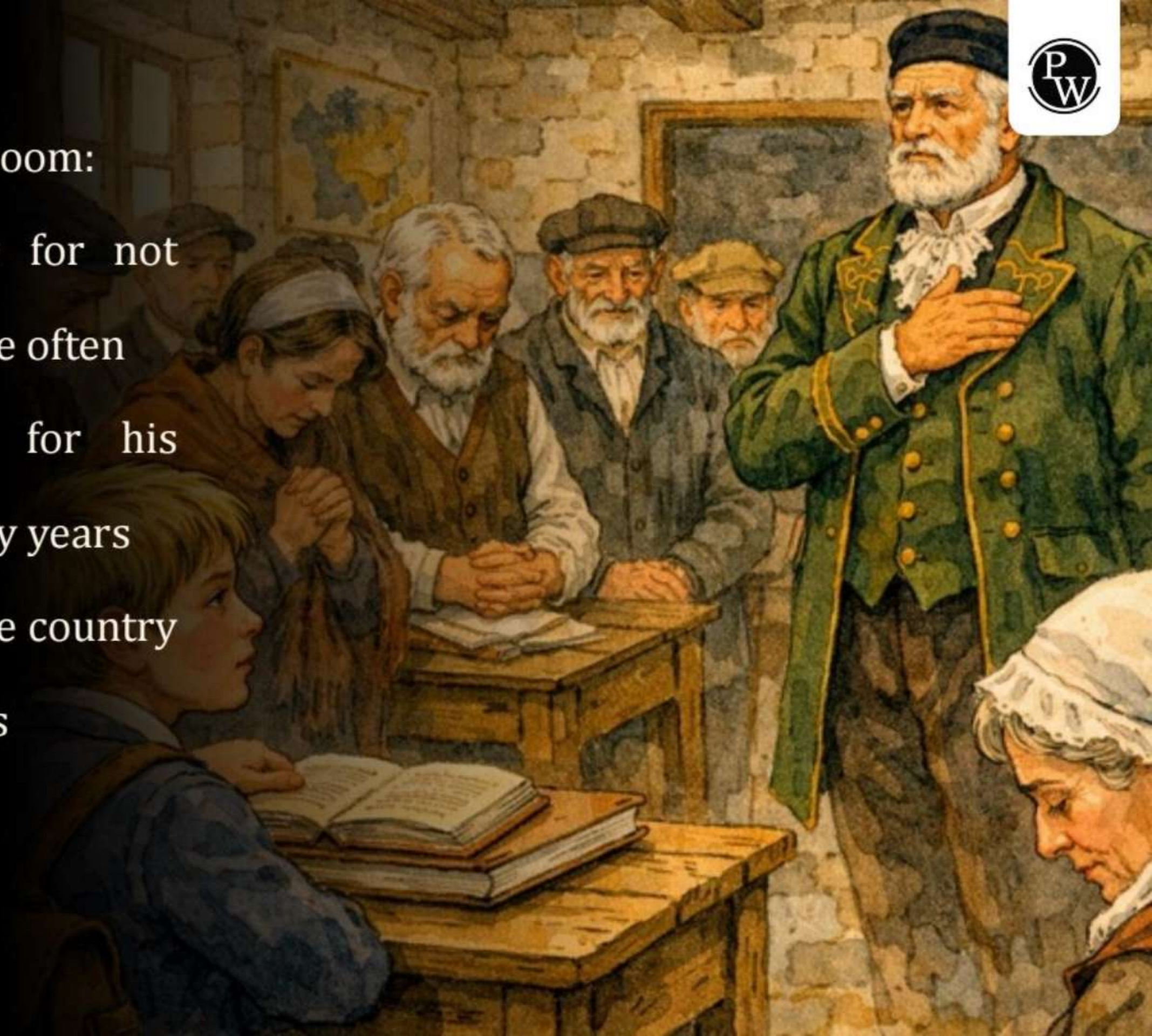


- deeply pained at the thought of M. Hamel going away
- forgot all about the teacher's ruler and his cranky nature.
- realised that M. Hamel had worn his fine Sunday clothes in honour of the last lesson.



A tribute by the villagers

- villagers gathered in the classroom:
 - as a sign of repentance for not having gone to school more often
 - to thank their master for his meritorious service of forty years
 - as a mark of respect for the country which was no longer theirs



Narrator's failure and the teacher's response

- Franz asked to recite the rule for participle
- wished that he was able to recite the rules flawlessly
- feels guilty on getting everything mixed up
- M. Hamel does not scold Franz
- comments upon man's nature of postponing things
- makes the students realise the irony of not being able to speak or write French in spite of being a Frenchman



Lack of learning: Hamel's view

- parents ignorant; not anxious to have their children learn
- children preferred to be put to work on farms or mills
- also blamed himself for sending children on errands for his convenience



Topic: Glossary



- **Dread : fear**
- **Strength to resist : voluntarily refuse a temptation**
- **The draft : conscription for military service i.e., the practice of ordering people by law to serve in the armed forces**
- **Apprentice : a person who works for an employer to learn an art or trade**
- **Bub : buddy; fellow**
- **Bustle : noise; movement**
- **Unison : in one voice; together**

- **Rapping** : striking or hitting against something making a noise
- **Counted on** : depended upon; banked on
- **Commotion** : sudden noisy confusion or excitement
- **Blushed** : became red in the face because of embarrassment or shame
- **Solemn** : serious
- **Primer** : an introductory book for teaching children
- **Thumbed at the edges** : (of pages) have creased and crumpled edges or corners
- **Mounted his chair** : seated or placed himself on chair

- **Grave : serious**
- **Thunderclap : sudden and jolting**
- **Wretches : evil persons**
- **Nuisance : troublesome**
- **Cranky : strange; bad-tempered**
- **Dreadful : terrible; very bad or unpleasant**
- **Daring : fearless**
- **Reproach : criticise or blame**

Thank
you

